

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1103

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Victoria Niederhauser, Dean of the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, College of Nursing on the occasion of her retirement.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pay tribute to those medical professionals, educators, and administrators who have wholly devoted themselves to serving others and thereby contribute significantly to the well-being of their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, Victoria Niederhauser, Dean of the College of Nursing at the University of Tennessee, Knoxville (UT), is taking her well-deserved retirement at the end of the 2025-2026 academic year after fifteen years of visionary leadership that transformed the college into a nationally recognized leader in nursing education, research, and practice; and

WHEREAS, Dean Niederhauser, DrPH, RN, PPCNP-BC, FAAN, was appointed to serve as the fourth dean of UT's College of Nursing in 2011, and since that time, she has led the college through a period of extraordinary growth and innovation; and

WHEREAS, during her tenure, enrollment has increased by more than 160 percent, and licensure pass rates have outpaced state and national averages, currently standing at a first-time NCLEX pass rate of 97.3 percent; UT College of Nursing's rankings have improved, with the Bachelor of Science in Nursing program and the Doctor of Nursing Practice program landing at No. 19 and No. 22, respectively, according the 2024/2025 *U.S. News & World Report* rankings; and

WHEREAS, Dean Niederhauser's advocacy for a new home of Vol Nursing, including leadership through appropriations process, design, and philanthropy, resulted in the August 2025 dedication of the UT Medical Nursing Building; on the whole, under her leadership, the

college has received more than \$33 million in research support and \$57 million in philanthropic support; and

WHEREAS, over the last fifteen years, she has helped grow a team of top nursing scientists who are conducting research that improves health locally and globally, including research that advances healthcare delivery (Precision Health, Telehealth, Simulation), bio behavioral science (Microbiome, Substance Use, Mental Health), and health services and policy (Workforce, Preventative Care, End of Life Care); and

WHEREAS, Dean Niederhauser has also built strong relationships with regional healthcare institutions that have not only resulted in unparalleled clinical learning opportunities for students but have also transformed into scholarship-generating ventures through the BSN Scholars Program (UT Medical Center) and Pediatric Registered Nurse Program (Dolly Parton Children's Hospital); these innovative academic-practice partnerships add more than 100 BSN graduates to Knoxville's hospital workforce, creating a pipeline that addresses a critical nurse shortage; and

WHEREAS, a respected leader among her peers in academia and health care, her professional tenure includes service with various national organizations, including the Beryl Institute, American Association of Colleges of Nursing (Board Director-at-Large, 2020-2024), Robert Wood Johnson Nurse Executive Fellows Alumni Association, Friends of the National Institute of Nursing Research (President, 2023-2025), and American Academy of Nursing; and

WHEREAS, Dean Niederhauser has also devoted herself to serving the Knoxville and University communities, serving with the Dolly Parton Children's Hospital Board of Directors (current Vice Chair), Leadership Knoxville (2014), Leadership Tennessee (2019), and University of Tennessee Leadership Institute (2017); and

WHEREAS, in 2015, she was named a Fellow of the American Academy of Nursing, an organization representing the most accomplished nursing leaders in policy, research, practice, and education; and

WHEREAS, Victoria Niederhauser is a board-certified pediatric nurse practitioner and the author of more than sixty-five articles and book chapters on child health and educational issues, as well as the book *Core Review for Pediatric Primary Care Nurse Practitioners*; and

WHEREAS, her career has been defined by innovation, compassion, and her unwavering commitment to advancing the nursing profession, and the focus of her scholarly work has been child and adolescent Health Promotion and Disease Prevention, with an emphasis on immunizations; her funding for nursing research and training grants totals over \$16 million; and

WHEREAS, throughout her many worthy endeavors, Dean Niederhauser has enjoyed the love and support of her husband, Stewart McCorkle; children, Travis (Cory) Niederhauser, Matt (Tracey) Niederhauser, Emily (Myles) Niederhauser Lund; stepchildren, Parker McCorkle and Taylor McCorkle; and grandchildren, Grayson, Griffin, Kea, Noa, Lachlan, and Maren; and

WHEREAS, Dean Niederhauser has been a tireless advocate for students, faculty, and the nursing profession; her legacy will continue to inspire others as they build upon the solid foundation she helped create; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that we recognize Victoria Niederhauser for her countless and indelible contributions to UT's College of Nursing on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we extend to Dean Victoria Niederhauser our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement, applaud her dedication to the nursing

profession and the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, and wish her much happiness and every continued success in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.